./how_to_read_the_codes

How to Read the Codes

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Used in **El's Wrench Attack Coding Tool 2026** and **Map My Risk**
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MY DEFINITION OF A WRENCH ATTACK

Any event in which a person is targeted with **physical force**, **credible threat of physical force**, **real-world psychological coercion**, or **deception involving real-world presence** — with intent to compel the transfer, disclosure, or surrender of cryptocurrency or cryptographic access credentials (private keys, seed phrases, PINs, or passwords).

A burglary where the victim is absent does **NOT** qualify — for properly stored Bitcoin, coercion of the holder is the only viable theft mechanism. This is what makes wrench attacks a categorically new crime type, not simply robbery adapted for a new asset class.

TYPE A — Criminology classification · multiple allowed

A-OP	**Opportunistic** — no prior planning; chance discovery the victim holds crypto
A-TG	**Targeted** — specific victim selected on confirmed intelligence
A-RP	**Repeat victimisation** — same victim attacked more than once, or known from a prior attack
A-PX	**Proxy targeting** — relative or associate targeted as leverage to reach the holder

TYPE B — Level of planning

B-1	**Opportunistic** — zero planning
B-2	**Semi-planned** — target identified, not thoroughly researched; minimal coordination
B-3	**Fully planned** — research, surveillance, set entry method, briefed co-offenders, equipment
B-4	**Organised** — all of B-3 plus at least one of: transnational network; division of labour (intelligence / execution / laundering); purchased or leaked data; orchestrator remote from the scene

TYPE C — Violence continuum · highest level reached

C-0	**Non-contact / psychological** — remote threat only
C-1	**Threat only (real-world)** — threatening presence, no physical contact
C-2	**Minor violence / restraint** — contact or restraint, no serious injury
C-3	**Serious violence** — injury with weapons, significant assault, sexual violence, prolonged captivity with violence
C-4	**Kidnapping / captivity** — deprived of liberty for an extended period
C-5	**Homicide** — victim killed during or as a result of the attack

CONF — Confidence rating · how well verified

A	**Court / LEA verified** — court documents, police press releases or indictments
B	**Multi-source corroborated** — two or more independent credible media sources
C	**Single source** — one credible media report
D	**Community report** — unverified, internally consistent, uncorroborated

TYPE D — Relational status · offender to victim

D-S	**Stranger** — no prior contact
D-P	**Pseudo-stranger** — posed as delivery driver, police, OTC buyer or business contact
D-A	**Acquaintance** — known socially or professionally
D-I	**Intimate / family** — genuine partner, spouse, parent, child
D-R	**Romance lure** — offender built or faked a romantic or dating relationship to reach the victim
D-B	**Business associate** — current or former business partner, employee or provider

TYPE E — Access method · multiple allowed

E-UW	**Unlocked wallet** — device already unlocked or wallet open
E-PW	**Password / PIN coercion**
E-SP	**Seed phrase disclosure**
E-AT	**Approved transaction** — victim forced to sign a transfer
E-LN	**Lightning Network**
E-MX	**Multi-sig coercion**

CODING RULES

- **UNKNOWN** — the reporting doesn't say
- **N/A** — the field doesn't apply (e.g. no crypto was taken)
- **Violence** is coded at the highest level reached
- **PROVISIONAL** — proposed code not yet reviewed by me; may change
- **Multiple codes** allowed for Type A and Type E only
- **Outside my definition** — coded, but flagged as not a wrench attack

SOURCE & METHOD

Cases come from **Jameson Lopp's Known Physical Bitcoin Attacks** database. Each case is coded from Lopp's summary and the source he links, with AI assistance under these rules, then reviewed and recoded by me where I disagree. Not every case in Lopp's database meets my definition. Codes may change as fuller reporting emerges.